Kawshik Ray

PhD (IIT Kanpur) | Assistant Professor of English

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Amity University Kolkata, West Bengal, India

Academic Appointments

Amity University Kolkata 2023 – present

Assistant Professor of English, Amity Institute of English Studies and Research

Courses taught: Business Communication; Modern Indian English Literature; Literary Theory; English Drama (Elizabethan to Restoration Age)

Education

Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur 2015 – 2022

PhD, English — Department of Humanities and Social Sciences

Cumulative Performance Index: 9.67 / 10.00

Thesis: *ANT-Ecocriticism in the Anthropocene: Latourian Readings of Select Planetary Fiction*

Visiting Student: Utrecht University, The Netherlands — Posthuman Ethics in the Anthropocene (2017)

University of Calcutta 2011 – 2013

Master of Arts, English Literature — First Class

Percentage: 60%

Ramakrishna Mission Vidyamandira, University of Calcutta 2008 – 2011

Bachelor of Arts (Honours), English Literature

Percentage: 55.4% | General subjects: Political Science, Economics

Research Interests

Environmental Humanities; Critical Climate Change; The Anthropocene; Planetary Cosmopolitics; Contemporary Planetary Fiction; Climate Change Fiction (Cli-Fi); Actor-Network Theory (Bruno Latour); Ethnography of Science and Technology; Posthumanism; Dalit Feminist Studies; Intersectionality

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. Ray, Kawshik. "The Emerging Political Actors in the Anthropocene: Cosmopolitics of the Earthbounds in Amitav Ghosh's *Gun Island*." *Environmental Humanities*, Duke University Press. ISSN 2201-1919. [Accepted; forthcoming] **Q1 Scopus Indexed.**
2. Ray, Kawshik. "A Comparative Reading of Bama's *Karukku* and Baby Kamble's *The Prisons We Broke*: A Dalit Feminist Approach." *Contemporary Voice of Dalits*, SAGE Publications. ISSN 2455-328X. doi: 10.1177/2455328X251356. Indexed in Web of Science
3. Ray, Kawshik. "Ecology as a Fact: 'Rescuing' Nature from Discourse — An Ecocritical Reading of Two Poems of Robert Frost." *Daath Voyage*, vol. 4, no. 3, September 2019, pp. 38–46. ISSN 2455-7544.

4. Ray, Kawshik. "Towards an Ecological Ethics: A Reading of Cormac McCarthy's *The Road*." *Daath Voyage*, vol. 2, no. 4, December 2017, pp. 119–131. ISSN 2455-7544.
5. Ray, Kawshik. "The Plurality of Immigrant Experiences: Mrs. Sen's Imaginary Homeland." *GNOSIS*, vol. 4, no. 1, October 2017, pp. 163–168. ISSN 2394-0131.

Conference Proceedings

6. Ray, Kawshik. "Mental Imagery for Effective Education: Literature and Learning." *Proceedings of the International Seminar on Enhancing Quality in Education*, University of Calcutta, 19 August 2015. ISBN 978-81-923675-2-1.

Conference Activity

Papers Presented

- "Composing a Plural Collective: A Latourian Reading of Vandana Singh's Cli-fi *Entanglement*." Panel: 'Seeing Past the Nature/Culture Dualism' (Chair: Prof. Karla Armbruster). ASLE Biennial International Conference, *Paradise on Fire*. University of California, Davis, 26–30 June 2019.
- "Mental Imagery for Effective Education: Literature and Learning." International Seminar on Enhancing Quality in Education, University of Calcutta / Ramakrishna Mission Shikshan Mandira, 19 August 2015.

Panels & Workshops

- Panel Discussant. Second Sunanda Sanyal Memorial National Seminar, 'Dystopian Universes: Postapocalyptic and Futuristic Representations of Climate and Nature in Speculative Fiction.' Department of English, Ramakrishna Mission Vidyamandira, University of Calcutta, 11–12 March 2025.
- Panel Discussant. 'Fire in the Belly': Workshop on Petrocultures. University of California, Davis, 30 June 2019.

Symposia & Seminars Attended

- Annual Literature Festival 'Litfiesta 4.0.' Amity University Kolkata, 6–7 November 2025.
- National Seminar: 'Indian Knowledge System: Bridging Traditions with Modernity.' Amity University Kolkata / Maulana Abul Kalam Azad Institute of Asian Studies, 22 August 2025.
- FDP: 'Posthumanism: Critique and Critics.' Amity Institute of English Studies and Research, Amity University Kolkata, 21–25 July 2025.
- FDP: 'Innovative Pedagogy for Teaching Foreign Languages in Multidisciplinary Contexts.' Amity School of Foreign Languages, Amity University Kolkata, 7–11 July 2025.
- FDP: 'Digital Humanities, Linguistics, and ELT in the Post-Pandemic World.' Amity University Kolkata / Indian Statistical Institute Kolkata, 24–28 June 2024.
- FDP: 'Evidence-Based Approaches in Child and Adolescent Mental Health.' Amity Institute of Psychology & Allied Sciences, Amity University Kolkata, 15–19 July 2024.
- International Seminar: 'The Concept of Morality: Indian and Western.' Department of Philosophy, Ramakrishna Mission Vidyamandira, 29–30 September 2015.
- Symposium: 'Connecting Texts: Literature, Theatre, and Cinema.' Department of Research Support, University of Calcutta, 23–25 March 2015.

Previous Teaching Experience

IIT Kanpur — Department of Humanities and Social Sciences 2016 – 2020

- Tutor, Soft Skills (HSS401A), under Prof. T. Ravichandran — 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019
- Tutor, Communication Skills (COM200), under Prof. T. Ravichandran — 2019
- Teaching Assistant to Prof. Mini Chandran — 2018
- Teaching Assistant & Team Leader, NPTEL MOOC AICTE-Approved FDP Courses: Developing Soft Skills and Personality; Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality — 2016–2020
- Mentored and supervised incoming Teaching Assistants in NPTEL MOOC programme

Grants, Awards, and Honours

ASLE Travel Award — Association for the Study of Literature and Environment 2019
Department Excellence Grant — IIT Kanpur 2017, 2019
Second Place, UGC Junior Research Fellowship — English June 2015
UGC National Eligibility Test (NET) — Qualified for Assistant Professorship in English December 2014

Other Scholarly and Creative Work

- Ethnographic documentary photograph from *Street-Dwellers in Calcutta* (Certificate Course in Photography, University of Calcutta, 2013) published by **BBC UK**, 17 April 2013. Available at: bbc.com/news/in-pictures-22169230
- Certificates in Photography, National Service Scheme, Spiritual Heritage, Drama, and Extempore Speech.

Languages and Technical Skills

Languages: English (full professional proficiency); Bengali (native); Hindi (proficient)
Research skills: Academic writing; ethnographic fieldwork; documentary photography; literary analysis; NPTEL/MOOC course delivery